

KNOWLEDGEABLE

Subconscious Learning Platform

Action Plan

June 2026

1. Pre-Launch Checklist

Before any development work begins, these items need to be in place. None of them cost significant money, but skipping them creates problems later.

Item	Action Required	Deadline	Status
Legal entity	Register as sole trader or Ltd company. Ltd is better if seeking investment later.	Week 1	Not started
Domain and branding	Secure knowledgeable domain name. Basic brand identity (logo, colour palette, tone of voice).	Week 1-2	Not started
App store accounts	Register Apple Developer (£79/year) and Google Play Developer (\$25 one-time).	Week 2	Not started
Privacy policy and terms	Draft GDPR compliant privacy policy and terms of service. Template based is fine for beta.	Week 3	Not started
Content licensing audit	Identify open access academic repositories and confirm usage rights for seeding content.	Week 2-3	Not started
Analytics setup	Implement basic analytics (Mixpanel or PostHog free tier) in the prototype.	Week 2	Not started
Payment integration	Stripe account setup and basic subscription flow. Can be tested in sandbox first.	Week 3-4	Not started

2. Phase 1: Closed Beta (Months 1-3)

The purpose of the closed beta is to answer one question. Do people actually come back to the app after the first day? If retention is poor, the concept needs rethinking before spending on growth.

Goals

200 to 500 invited users from 2 to 3 UK university campuses. Target engagement of 10 or more minutes per session and 30 day retention above 30%.

Month 1: Foundation

Task	Details	Owner
Convert prototype to mobile	Set up React Native project. Port core feed, content detail, and profile screens. Web version stays live as fallback.	Technical Lead
Seed content library	Load 500+ open access papers, 200+ book entries, 100+ curated summaries. Quality over quantity.	Content Lead
Recruit beta testers	Reach out to student societies at target universities. Offer "founding member" status. No paid incentives.	Founder
Set up moderation	Basic content review queue. Manual review for first 3 months. Automated flagging can come later.	Content Lead

Month 2: Launch and Observe

Task	Details	Owner
Release beta (TestFlight/internal track)	iOS TestFlight and Android internal testing track. Invite first 200 users.	Technical Lead

Daily engagement monitoring	Track DAU, session length, content views, social actions (follows, comments, shares).	Founder
Content creator onboarding	Recruit 20-30 early creators (students, book reviewers, science communicators) to post regularly.	Content Lead
Bug fixing and polish	Rapid iteration based on user feedback. Weekly builds.	Technical Lead

Month 3: Evaluate

Task	Details	Owner
Retention analysis	Calculate 30 day retention. Target above 30%. Below 20% is a stop signal.	Founder
Feature usage audit	Which features get used? Which are ignored? Cut or improve based on data.	All
User interviews	10-15 conversations with active and churned users. Why did they stay or leave?	Founder
Decision gate	Proceed to Phase 2 only if retention exceeds 25% and average session length exceeds 8 minutes.	All

3. Decision Gate 1

At the end of Month 3, the founding team reviews beta data. There are three possible outcomes.

Green light. Retention above 30%, sessions above 10 minutes, and users are posting original content. Move to Phase 2 as planned.

Amber. Retention between 20% and 30%, or sessions between 6 and 10 minutes. Extend beta by 4 weeks with targeted improvements before deciding.

Red. Retention below 20% or sessions below 6 minutes. The concept needs fundamental rethinking. Pause spending and investigate what is not working.

4. Phase 2: Open Beta (Months 4-6)

The open beta tests whether the app can grow beyond a curated group of early adopters. This is where organic growth and premium conversion start mattering.

Goals

Expand to 2,000 to 5,000 users. Launch premium subscription at £9.99 early adopter rate. Achieve 2% or higher free to premium conversion.

Month 4: Growth

Task	Details	Owner
Public app store release	Submit to Apple App Store and Google Play. Web version remains live.	Technical Lead
Social media campaign	Instagram, TikTok, and Reddit (academic subs). Content showing app in action. No paid ads yet.	Founder

Premium tier activation	Enable £9.99/month early adopter subscription via Stripe. AI explanations, no ads, full library.	Technical Lead
GCSE/A Level content	Begin loading structured revision content by subject. Start with 3-4 popular subjects.	Content Lead

Month 5-6: Scale and Monetise

Task	Details	Owner
Ad integration	Non intrusive adverts in free tier feed. Test formats (banner vs native vs interstitial).	Technical Lead
Content creator programme	Formalise creator invitations. Consider revenue sharing model for top creators (future).	Content Lead
Referral system	Simple invite link with tracking. Consider 1 week free premium for referrals.	Technical Lead
Performance optimisation	App speed, feed loading, search response times. Target under 2 second load for any screen.	Technical Lead

5. Decision Gate 2

End of Month 6. The key question now is whether the unit economics work.

Green. 3,000+ users, 2%+ premium conversion, positive user reviews. Move to full launch.

Amber. 1,500 to 3,000 users, sub 2% conversion. Test different price points (£7.99, £12.99). Extend beta by 6 weeks.

Red. Under 1,500 users despite marketing effort. The organic growth thesis is not working. Consider pivot to institutional (B2B) model or partnership with existing platform.

6. Phase 3: Full Public Launch (Months 7-9)

Full launch means the app is no longer in beta. The product is stable, monetisation is live, and the focus shifts from "does this work" to "how fast can this grow."

Task	Details	Timeline
Price increase to £15/month	Early adopters keep £9.99 rate for 6 months. New subscribers pay £15.	Month 7
Push notifications	Daily content suggestions. Follower activity alerts. Configurable by user.	Month 7
Offline reading (premium)	Download content for reading without internet. Key feature for commuters.	Month 8
Advanced personalisation	Improved feed algorithm based on reading history, saves, and engagement patterns.	Month 8-9
University partnerships	Approach student unions and library services. Offer bulk premium access.	Month 7-9
PR push	Pitch to education and tech press. Aim for coverage in TES, EdTech Magazine, or Wired UK.	Month 8

7. Phase 4: Growth and Expansion (Months 10-18)

By this point the app should be self sustaining from subscription and ad revenue. The focus moves to scaling users and exploring new revenue streams.

Task	Details	Timeline
Paid user acquisition	Instagram and TikTok ads targeting 18-25 year olds. Budget £2,000 to 5,000 per month initially.	Month 10+
Annual subscription option	Offer £120/year (2 months free) to improve retention and cash flow.	Month 10
Institutional licensing	B2B product for universities. Bulk premium access at discounted per seat rate.	Month 12+
Publisher partnerships	Approach academic publishers for licensed content deals. Revenue share model.	Month 12+
International expansion	Localisation for top English speaking markets (US, Australia, Canada). No translation yet.	Month 15+
Team expansion	Hire 2-3 additional developers, 1 marketing lead. Only if revenue supports it.	Month 12+

8. Budget Summary

The action plan is designed to be executable on a bootstrap budget. Year 1 total spending is projected at £120,000, funded through personal savings, a small friends and family round, or a startup loan.

Phase	Duration	Estimated Cost	Key Spend
Pre-launch	Weeks 1-4	£3,000 to 5,000	Legal, domains, app store accounts
Phase 1 (Closed Beta)	Months 1-3	£25,000 to 35,000	Development, content seeding, hosting
Phase 2 (Open Beta)	Months 4-6	£30,000 to 40,000	Marketing, premium features, moderation
Phase 3 (Full Launch)	Months 7-9	£30,000 to 40,000	Push features, partnerships, PR
Phase 4 (Growth)	Months 10-18	Revenue funded	Paid acquisition, team, expansion

The critical financial milestone is Month 14 to 16, when the business is projected to break even on a monthly basis. Until then, the total cash requirement is approximately £90,000 to £120,000.

Detailed financial projections, sensitivity analysis, and scenario modelling are provided in the accompanying Financial Model workbook.